



— RELOCATION GUIDE

Gisborne

Tairāwhiti

A relocation guide for healthcare professionals and their families. The work, the neighbourhoods, the money and the weekends in Gisborne.

The first city to see the sun. Work that makes a real difference.

Nau mai, haere mai ki Tairāwhiti. Gisborne is New Zealand's most easterly city and its most Māori region, a place that does things its own way. For clinicians who love breadth and community it is one of the most rewarding places to work in the country – and this guide will help you picture your life here.

~52k

people across the district

~53%

identify as Māori – the highest share in NZ

~1 hr

flight to Auckland or Wellington

2,200+

sunshine hours a year

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Guides describe places, not employers. Hospitals are described rather than named, and salaries, visas and registration rules change, so we confirm the detail with you directly.

Why clinicians choose Gisborne

If you love breadth, autonomy and a warm, close-knit community, Gisborne could be the most rewarding move you make.

Tairāwhiti means the coast upon which the sun shines across the water, and the region lives up to it: around 2,200 hours of sunshine, three rivers meeting at the city, and a long arc of surf coast running north to the East Cape and south to Māhia. This is where Cook first came ashore in 1769, and long before that where the waka Horouta and Tākitimu made landfall.

Clinical pay is set nationally, and housing here is among the more affordable in the North Island, so the money goes further. But the real draw is scope: a wider remit, more autonomy and work that visibly matters, in a close, capable team with real ownership of its work, in a region where your skills are genuinely valued.

WHO THRIVES HERE

Rural generalists and GPs

Breadth is the job, and the job is yours.

Emergency and community clinicians

Stabilise, decide, transfer — with a close team around you.

People who came for equity

If closing the gap is why you went into healthcare, few places offer more.

WORTH PLANNING FOR

Subspecialist work

Most hospital subspecialties are based in larger centres, so check your specialty first.

Travel home

Long-haul trips start with a short domestic flight — easy to plan around.

Specialist services

Complex care is provided in Hawke's Bay, Waikato or Auckland, with transfers well established.

○ Before work

A surf at Wainui or Makorori, fifteen minutes out, in the first daylight on earth. A lot of people here genuinely start the day this way.

○ Monday to Friday

10 MIN COMMUTE

From anywhere in the city. Free parking and an easy, unhurried drive.

○ After work

The rivers, Kaiti Hill for the view over Poverty Bay, or the beach again.

○ Saturday

The farmers' market, then a chardonnay cellar door or the coast road north.

○ Sunday

Rere Falls and the rockslide, the forest inland, or Māhia for the beach.



The koru, an unfurling fern frond: in Māori art it stands for new life and new beginnings.



Pīwakawaka (fantails) are friendly regulars in gardens and on bush tracks across the North Island.

The region at a glance

Three rivers meet the sea on New Zealand's most easterly point, with steep, soft hill country rising immediately behind. That geography gives the region its warmth, its wine, its surf and its character.

The city sits on the flats of Poverty Bay, where the Waimatā, Taruheru and Waipaoa rivers converge. Titirangi / Kaiti Hill rises above the harbour, and the surf beaches — Waikanae, Midway, Wainui and Makorori — run north from the city's edge. Behind the flats the land climbs quickly into dramatic, steep hill country: sheep and cattle stations and extensive pine forestry.

North, the coast road runs to Tolaga Bay, Tokomaru Bay and Ruatōria, and around the East Cape — an unhurried, beautiful, deeply Māori stretch of country. Inland lie the Raukūmara Range and Te Urewera. South, past the vineyards, the road runs to Māhia and on to Wairoa and Hawke's Bay.



From Titirangi / Kaiti Hill: the inner harbour, the rivers and the city on the flats, with the hill country behind.

Summer

DEC – FEB

Hot, dry and brilliant. The sun arrives here first – in midsummer, very early indeed.

Autumn

MAR – MAY

Harvest on the flats and clean swell on the coast. Many people's favourite season.

Winter

JUN – AUG

Mild on the flats, with some wet spells – a good season to check the roads before a long drive.

Spring

SEP – NOV

Warming and changeable, with the hills turning green; inland and up the coast stay a little cooler.



About Cyclone Gabrielle

In February 2023 Gabrielle hit Tairāwhiti as hard as anywhere in New Zealand: rivers broke out, bridges and roads were destroyed, slash and silt buried farmland and beaches, and coastal communities were cut off. Today the city is back to its usual rhythm, and coastal communities are rebuilding with real resilience. Colleagues here lived through it and pulled together – it helps to arrive informed and to ask with care.

THE REGION

Tairāwhiti

The coast upon which the sun shines across the water. Increasingly used officially.

THE CITY

Tūranganui-a-Kiwa

The name for Gisborne and Poverty Bay.

A PLACE AND AN IDENTITY

The Coast

The East Coast road north towards the Cape.

IWI

Ngāti Porou

The large iwi of the East Coast, north of the city.

KAITI HILL

Titirangi

The hill above the harbour, and the view.

FORESTRY DEBRIS

Slash

A word with real weight here since 2023.

Healthcare in Tairāwhiti

Two facts shape the work here more than any other: this is a rural hospital with real independence, four hours from the nearest base hospital, and over half the population it serves is Māori.

One public hospital in the city serves the whole district: an emergency department, inpatient medical and surgical beds, maternity, imaging, day procedures and outpatient clinics, with visiting specialists. Around it, general practice, iwi and Māori health providers, district nursing and rural clinics up the coast carry more weight than in most regions. Here community care is at the heart of the system.

Some care is shared with larger centres: intensive care beyond stabilisation, most subspecialties, oncology treatment and complex paediatrics go principally to the base hospital in Hawke's Bay, with Waikato and Auckland for tertiary services. Retrieval and air transfer are a well-practised part of the week.

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hospital at the heart of the district

4 hrs

to the nearest base hospital

Waikato and Auckland further again

>50%

of patients Māori

the highest share in the country

FIT	PROFESSIONS
Strong fit	Rural generalist medicine, general practice, emergency nursing and medicine, midwifery, radiography, community allied health, mental health and addiction, paramedicine, public and Māori health
Good options, with planning	Sonography, physiotherapy, occupational therapy, aged care, and roles combining a caseload with travel up the coast
Best suited to larger centres	Most hospital subspecialties, intensive care, radiation therapy and oncology

This is the rohe of Ngāti Porou, Rongowhakaata, Ngāi Tāmanuhiri, Te Aitanga-a-Māhaki and others, and iwi-led providers deliver a substantial share of care. Karakia opens meetings, te reo is used freely and whānau are present in decisions. For many patients, Kaupapa Māori services are the main pathway of care. You can arrive knowing very little te reo; a genuine willingness to learn is warmly welcomed.



Regional practice means knowing your patients and walking alongside them.



A clinician heading in for a shift.

What to ask at interview

- ☐ What senior support is available, on site and by phone, overnight and at weekends? Ask this first.
- ☐ What is referred out, where to, and what is my role in stabilising and transferring?
- ☐ How much coastal outreach is in the role, and how is travel planned around the weather?
- ☐ What orientation, cultural induction and te reo support is there for clinicians new to New Zealand?
- ☐ Is there relocation and housing support, and what does the team's retention look like?

Where to live in Gisborne

Everywhere is ten minutes from the hospital, so the choice is about what you want your street to be – town, beach, or the flats out among the vines. Good homes are popular, so start looking early.

TOWN · CHARACTER HOUSING

Central & Whataupoko

Leafy streets north of the rivers, near the Botanical Gardens. The most sought-after part of town, and still great value by national standards.

TOWN · FAMILY HOMES

Mangapapa

Settled family housing well served by schools. A common first house for relocating families.

TOWN · GOOD VALUE

Riverdale & Lytton West

Mixed suburbs west of the river with good-value family homes.

BENEATH TITIRANGI

Kaiti

The largest and most strongly Māori suburb, with real community strength. The most affordable housing, and where much of the most important health work happens.

10–15 MIN · SURF COAST

Wainui Beach

The premium address and, for many, the reason they came. Be ready to move when a home comes up.

~20 MIN · QUIETER COAST

Okitu & Makorori

Peaceful coastal living, with the surf at the end of the drive.

10–20 MIN · THE FLATS

Matawhero & Patutahi

Lifestyle blocks, land and space among the vines – the option most regions can't offer.

45 MIN + · ITS OWN DECISION

Up the Coast

Close-knit, strongly Māori communities with their own rural clinics, in beautiful country where it pays to plan travel around the weather.



Palms and Edwardian shopfronts on the city's main street.



Wainui Beach, ten to fifteen minutes north: the district's premium address.

Three things to check before you sign

- ☐ Availability, not price. Good rentals move quickly – ask your employer what accommodation support exists, and start early.
- ☐ Insulation, ventilation and heating. Many homes are older character builds; ask for the Healthy Homes statement and look for a heat pump.
- ☐ Flood and slip history. Worth checking, especially on the river flats and up the coast; ask about history and insurability.

Getting around

Inside Gisborne, getting around takes ten minutes and no thought. For longer trips, the airport five minutes from town is the key to it all.

Your commute is ten minutes from anywhere in the city to the hospital, on flat streets with free parking at both ends; the beaches add five or ten. If you have come from a large city, this is the daily change you will love most.

Longer road trips reward a little planning. Gisborne's two main land routes – south on SH2 to Wairoa and Napier, and north-west through the Waioeka Gorge to Ōpōtiki – both cross spectacular steep country. After heavy rain, locals simply check the roads before setting off, and for longer trips most people fly.

10 min

across the city

5 min

city to airport

~1 hr

flying to Auckland
or 6–7 hours by
road

4 hr

by road to Napier



Flat, small and warm: many clinicians here cycle or walk to work.

What this means in practice

- ✓ The airport keeps you connected: daily flights to Auckland and Wellington, five minutes from town.
- ✓ Check road conditions before any long drive, especially in winter and after heavy rain.
- ✓ Most households run a car, and the city bus network covers the main routes.
- ✓ Long-haul connects via Auckland or Wellington – allow a full day at each end.
- ✓ Keep a well-stocked pantry, as locals do – a sensible country habit.



The historic swing bridge in the Waioeka Gorge, on the inland road (SH2) towards Ōpōtiki and the Bay of Plenty.

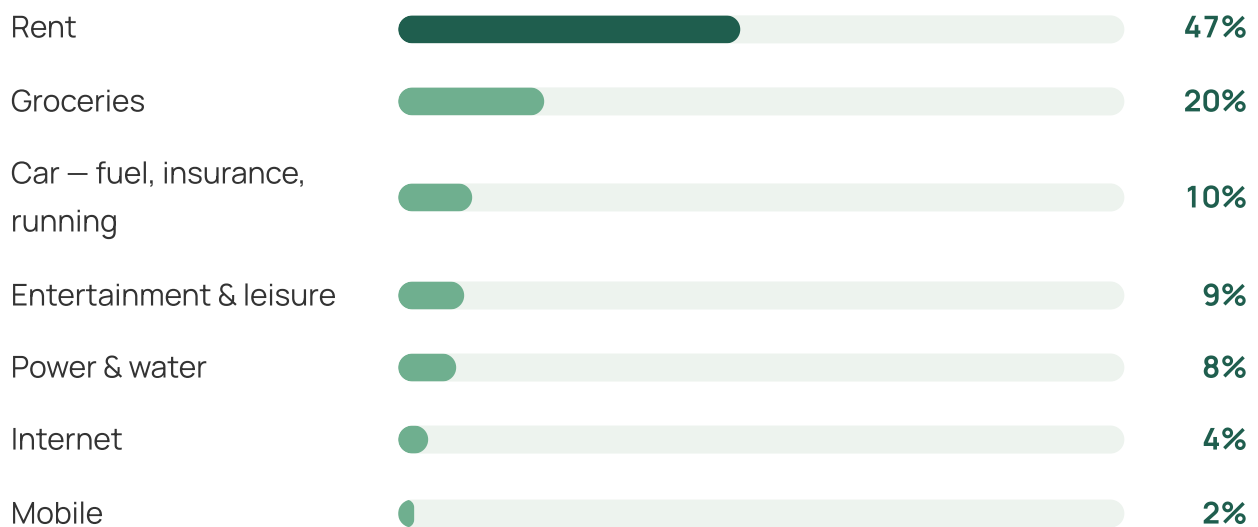
What it costs to live here

Housing costs less than almost anywhere with a hospital, which is a real advantage. Some everyday goods carry a little extra freight. We no longer print prices – they go stale – so here is the shape instead.

Clinical pay is national, so you arrive on the Auckland salary into a market where a family home costs a fraction of theirs. Buying on a single clinical salary is realistic, and a good number of clinicians do it within their first year or two.

The thing to plan for is timing rather than price: good rentals are popular, so start early and ask about accommodation support. Within the district there is a clear ladder: Whataupoko and Wainui at the top, Mangapapa and Riverdale in the middle, Kaiti and Elgin the most affordable, the rural settlements the best value of all.

Where a month goes



proportions, not amounts – one person on a mid-range budget

Costs worth planning for

- ✓ Freight and the weekly shop: allow a little extra for groceries and delivered goods, and a day or two more for online orders.
- ✓ Insurance and flood exposure: check a property's history and insurability before committing.
- ✓ Flights: most trips start with a domestic leg, so it is worth budgeting for them.
- ✓ Winter heating in an older house: a well-insulated home with a heat pump is usually cheaper overall.

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Rent takes under half of the month here, which is a real advantage in New Zealand – and a big part of the financial case for Tairāwhiti.



Seasonal produce at a weekend market: eating well costs less when you buy what is in season.



Green-lipped mussels, a New Zealand favourite and an affordable treat.



SOPHIE'S INSIGHTS

What I tell people about Gisborne

Gisborne is the region I am most careful about matching, and the one where the right person does the most good. I start every conversation about it with the distance and the senior-support question, because getting those right is what helps someone thrive.

The clinicians who thrive here came into healthcare to work where the need is greatest, and they arrive excited to learn to reo and be part of the community. When that lines up, it is the most rewarding placement I make.

If you are looking for big-city buzz, Gisborne is not that. But if you want sunshine, surf and a community that takes you in, the people who stay longest tell me that community is the reason.

Sophie Careem

Founder & Director, Ethicare Resourcing



Day one: a family arrives in Tairāwhiti to start a new chapter.

Food, wine and everyday life

A region that eats beautifully, straight from the land and the sea.

Gisborne calls itself the chardonnay capital of New Zealand and has the record to back it; this is aromatic white country rather than red. Cellar doors at Matawhero and Patutahi, ten to twenty minutes out, are relaxed and welcoming, with time to talk. Citrus, sweetcorn, avocados and persimmons come off the flats at roadside stalls, and the Saturday farmers' market is the weekend fixture.

Off the coast: crayfish, pāua, kina, snapper and kahawai, with a deep culture of gathering kai moana — up the Coast, customary practice rather than recreation. There are clear rules and proper tikanga around it, and locals are generous in explaining both.



Evenings are intimate and characterful — a cinema-bar in a restored heritage building.



Evening over the flats west of the city, the fertile country that grows the region's grapes and produce.

The rhythm of the year

- ✓ New Year is the region's big moment — the first city in the world to see it, and it makes something of it.
- ✓ Matariki and the Māori calendar matter here; marae events, kapa haka and hui are part of the community year.
- ✓ Summer is hot and buzzing: a surf town at full tilt, easing into a golden February.
- ✓ Community welcomes you steadily, then completely. Turn up consistently — sport, kapa haka, the surf club, the school gate.

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Good to know

Everyday shopping is all in town; for a big shopping day, Napier is a road trip away and Auckland a short flight. Rhythm and Vines brings a big music festival every New Year, and touring shows make a fun excuse for a city weekend. If a particular cuisine is central to how your family eats, check which specialist groceries are stocked locally; online ordering covers the rest.



A glass among the vines: wine is part of everyday life on the flats.

Surf beaches, rivers and forest

Gisborne's beaches, rivers and forests are close, uncrowded and, most weekends, almost yours alone.



A bay on the East Coast north of the city – one of many on the road to the Cape.

The surf is the main event. Wainui, Makorori and the beaches north of the city catch swell from the whole eastern Pacific, and they are consistent, varied and – the part people cannot quite believe – uncrowded. Add Māhia for longer point breaks, and Waikanae and Midway for a swim after work. A meaningful number of the clinicians who move here do so because of this paragraph.



Surf schools, boardriders clubs and a genuine local culture around the water.

~50 MIN

Rere Falls & the rockslide

A wide waterfall and a natural rock slide into a pool.
A regional institution.

~1 HOUR

Eastwoodhill Arboretum

The national arboretum. Extraordinary in autumn.

IN TOWN

Titirangi / Kaiti Hill

The view over Poverty Bay and a significant pā site.
The after-work walk.

IN TOWN

Tairāwhiti Museum

Waka landings, Cook's arrival and the layered history since. Worth going early.

IN TOWN

The rivers

Three rivers meet in the city, with walkways, rowing and swimming holes along them.

~15 MIN

Te Kuri Farm Walkway

A farm walk above Wainui with big views over the bay and the coast.

What people actually do at the weekend

- ✓ The Saturday morning farmers' market, then a coffee in town.
- ✓ Walk or bike the Oneroa coastal walkway along the city beachfront.
- ✓ Club sport, kapa haka and surf lifesaving nippers — how families meet people.
- ✓ An early surf at Wainui or Makorori, or a swim at Waikanae and Midway.
- ✓ Take the kids to Rere Falls and the rockslide in summer.
- ✓ A long lunch at a cellar door on the flats, or a drive up the coast to Tolaga Bay.



Makorori, a few minutes beyond Wainui on the coast road north. State Highway 35 carries on from here around the Cape.

State Highway 35 runs around three hundred and thirty kilometres from Gisborne around the Cape to Ōpōtiki, through Tolaga Bay, Tokomaru Bay, Ruatōria and Hicks Bay. It is one of the great New Zealand drives. The communities along it are still rebuilding after Gabrielle, so take it slowly, buy your petrol and lunch locally, and enjoy the places you pass through as communities rather than scenery.

Day trips along the East Coast

Beyond the city lies some of New Zealand's most unspoilt country: the East Coast road to the Cape, the Māhia peninsula, and the forests of Te Urewera.

North, State Highway 35 runs up the coast through Tolaga Bay and Tokomaru Bay to the East Cape lighthouse and on to Ōpōtiki – a road trip best taken over several days. South, Māhia has beaches and point breaks, and inland from Wairoa, Lake Waikaremoana sits in Te Urewera, with one of the country's Great Walks.

Hawke's Bay is the nearest bigger centre: Napier and Hastings, with their wineries, Art Deco streets and shopping, are three to four hours south by road. For a big city, most people fly – Auckland and Wellington are each about an hour away.

GETTING TO	ROUGHLY	WHY GO
Waikanae & Midway beaches	~5 min	Swimming beaches in town, with surf lifesaving clubs
Wainui & Makorori	10–20 min	The nearest surf – consistent and uncrowded
Ski fields: Whakapapa & Tūroa, Mt Ruapehu	~6 hrs by road	A winter road trip or long weekend in the snow
Napier & Hastings	~3–4 hrs	The nearest bigger centre: wine, Art Deco, shopping
Auckland	~1 hr flight (6–7 hrs by road)	New Zealand's biggest city, and the international airport
Gisborne Airport	~5 min	Daily flights to Auckland and Wellington
Tolaga Bay	~45 min	The historic wharf and the start of the coast road north
Rere Falls	~50 min	The waterfall and natural rockslide
Māhia	~1 hr 45	Beaches, point breaks and the rocket launch site

GETTING TO	ROUGHLY	WHY GO
Lake Waikaremoana	~2 hrs 30	The Great Walk in Te Urewera

~45 MIN

Tolaga Bay

A long, historic wharf stretching out into the bay, a beach and the coastal Cooks Cove walkway.

A FEW DAYS

The East Cape road

Around the Cape to Ōpōtiki: marae, wharves, uncrowded beaches and the lighthouse at the edge of the map.

~1 HR 45

Māhia

A peninsula of beaches and point breaks, popular for summer holidays and fishing.

~2 HRS 30

Te Urewera & Waikaremoana

One of the North Island's largest native forests, with a Great Walk around the lake.

~2 HRS 30

Whakatāne & Ōhope

Through the Waioeka Gorge to the eastern Bay of Plenty and a favourite family beach.

~3-4 HRS

Napier & Hastings

Hawke's Bay's wineries, Art Deco streets and bigger shops — a classic long weekend.



Napier's Art Deco centre, in Hawke's Bay — three to four hours south by road.



A family day at Whakapapa on Mt Ruapehu, the nearest ski fields — a winter road-trip adventure from Gisborne.

Growing up in Tairāwhiti

For an outdoor childhood, wonderful — surf, space, safety and sunshine, with a strong bicultural upbringing. A few practical things are worth planning early.

Children here grow up outdoors: the beach after school, the rivers in summer, the rockslide at Rere and plenty of park and playground space in a city where nothing is far. The council runs the city's pools, libraries and parks, and surf lifesaving nippers, rugby, netball, waka ama and kapa haka are where children make friends. The pace is gentle, and close-knit.

Many local schools place strong emphasis on te reo and tikanga, reflecting the region, and small class sizes and a close community are often highlighted as strengths. As everywhere in New Zealand there are state schools, state-integrated (often church) schools, and Māori-medium options including kura kaupapa Māori and bilingual units.

Secondary options include the long-established Gisborne Boys' High School and Gisborne Girls' High School, alongside co-educational schools. Popular schools are zoned by address, so visit them before you choose a street. Some specialist paediatric and allied health services are based in Hawke's Bay or beyond, so check ahead if your child needs them.

For under-fives there are kindergartens, daycares, playcentres and kōhanga reo, and 20 hours of free early childhood education for three- to five-year-olds. EIT has a Tairāwhiti campus in the city with vocational and degree programmes.

Choosing a school from overseas

- ✓ Read any school's Education Review Office (ERO) report at ero.govt.nz — the independent view of how it is doing.
- ✓ Check the school's enrolment zone against the exact address before you sign a lease.
- ✓ Ask about te reo Māori and bilingual options — a real strength here.
- ✓ Children usually start school on or after their fifth birthday, and must be enrolled by six.



Beach walks after school are an ordinary part of family life in New Zealand.



Time outdoors together is a big part of why families make the move.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- ✓ Rural hospital practice is a rewarding, different job — ask about senior support first.
- ✓ Housing is affordable but in demand: start early and ask about accommodation support.
- ✓ Te reo and tikanga are part of ordinary working life; effort is noticed.
- ✓ Fly for long trips — the airport is five minutes from town.
- ✓ Want a base hospital with similar sunshine? Hawke's Bay is the neighbouring region to the south.

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Gisborne suits clinicians who want their skills stretched and their work to count double.

Your Gisborne address book

Gisborne's migrant communities are small but active, held together by the Tairāwhiti Multicultural Council and its drop-in hub on Gladstone Road, a Sikh community of around 150 families with its own gurdwara since 2024, and Muslim, Chinese, Filipino and Pacific groups. Specialist food and faith options are the narrowest of any region, so most families top up from Auckland, Hawke's Bay or online.

COUNCIL AND GETTING AROUND

Gisborne District Council

The unitary council: rates, rubbish, water, roads, the city bus and civil defence

gdc.govt.nz

NZTA Journey Planner

Live road conditions and closures on SH2 and SH35

journeys.nzta.govt.nz

Department of Conservation

Tracks, campsites and alerts across the district

doc.govt.nz

SETTLING IN

Tairāwhiti Gisborne

The regional visitor guide: beaches, wine, events and the East Cape

tairawhitigisborne.co.nz

Tairāwhiti Museum

The region's museum and art gallery, a good first afternoon

tairawhitimuseum.org.nz

Citizens Advice Bureau

Free, confidential help with tenancy, employment and everyday questions

cab.org.nz

Ministry for Ethnic Communities

Settlement information and community connections for new migrants

ethniccommunities.govt.nz

COMMUNITY & CULTURAL ASSOCIATIONS

Tairāwhiti Multicultural Council

The region's umbrella group for migrant communities; runs Diwali/Festival of Lights, the International Food Festival and Multicultural Women's Day. Drop-in hub at 261 Gladstone Road, Tuesday and Thursday mornings

trusttairawhiti.nz/news/tairawhiti-multicultural-council

Gisborne Chinese Association

Local branch of the NZ Chinese Association, founded in 1926; celebrates Chinese New Year, Ching Ming and the Moon Festival

gisborne.nzchinese.org.nz

Tairāwhiti Filipino Society

Gisborne's Filipino association, listed by the Philippine Embassy; ask at the multicultural hub for current contacts

philembassy.org.nz

Pacific Islanders' Community Trust (PICT)

Pasifika social, education, immigration and financial support, with Whānau Ora services; 395 Palmerston Road

06 868 5620

healthpoint.co.nz/pacific-people-3/tairawhiti/gisborne

Literacy Aotearoa Ikaroa Rāwhiti (Gisborne)

Free adult literacy, communication, digital and driver-education courses at 100 Grey Street; ask about English (ESOL) help, which the immigration website lists under Turanga Ararau

06 867 5953 literacy.org.nz

English Language Partners (online classes)

There is no Gisborne centre, but the national provider runs online English classes, and many are free for residents

englishlanguage.org.nz

Citizens Advice Bureau

Free, confidential help with tenancy, employment, consumer and settling-in questions, including a directory of local English-class providers

cab.org.nz

Shakti

Specialist support for migrant and refugee women and children affected by family violence; free and confidential

0800 742 584 shakti.org.nz

Gizzy Local

Local events listings covering the farmers' market, the Diwali festival at Marina Park and community happenings

gizzylocal.com

FACEBOOK & ONLINE GROUPS

Gisborne Tairāwhiti Muslim Association (Facebook)

Prayer times, Ramadan and Eid arrangements, and community notices

facebook.com/Gisbornemuslims

Gisborne Anglican Parish (Facebook)

Holy Trinity's service times and community events

facebook.com/gisborneanglicanparish

Gizzy Local (Facebook)

What's on in Gisborne each week, including cultural festivals and markets

facebook.com/gizzylocalnz

Diverse Tairāwhiti

Contact for the multicultural hub's bookings and enquiries (email diversetairawhiti@gmail.com); ask there for the current WhatsApp and Facebook groups for each community

gisborneherald.co.nz/news/multicultural-hub-opens-in-gladstone-road

PLACES OF WORSHIP

St Mary's Star of the Sea Catholic Church

Gisborne's Catholic parish (Diocese of Hamilton), 51 Campion Road, Te Hapara

06 867 7224

gcatholic.org/churches/oceania/41670

Holy Trinity, Anglican Parish of Gisborne

City-centre Anglican church with a strongly bicultural congregation

waiapuanglicans.org.nz/eastland

Anglican Parish of Waipaoa

St Luke's at Waerenga-a-hika, serving the Poverty Bay flats

facebook.com/waipaoa.anglican.parish

Gurudwara Sahib Gisborne

Gisborne's first gurdwara, 7 Solander Street, opened at Vaisakhi in April 2024 by the local Sikh sangat

gisborneherald.co.nz/news/historic-moment-for-gisbornes-sikh-community-celebration-at-temple-opening

Gisborne Tairāwhiti Muslim Association

Daily prayers, weekly Qur'an study, Ramadan and Eid; message the Facebook page for the prayer venue

facebook.com/Gisbornemuslims

Gisborne Seventh-day Adventist Church

Saturday worship and ministries

gisborne.adventist.org.nz

The Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints, Gisborne Stake

Several wards across the city; use the meetinghouse finder for addresses and times

churchofjesuschrist.org/maps/meetinghouses

Iglesia Ni Cristo, Gisborne

Filipino congregation, holding services in Gisborne since 2023

pasugo.com.ph/new-gws-established-in-gisborne-new-zealand

Hindu worship

There's no Hindu temple in Gisborne; Diwali is celebrated through the multicultural council. The Hindu Council lists temples elsewhere in the North Island

hcnz.org

Jewish community

There's no synagogue or Jewish congregation locally; the NZ Jewish Council can connect you with the congregations in Wellington and Auckland

nzjc.org.nz

HALAL, KOSHER & INTERNATIONAL GROCERIES

Bollywood Spice Store

Indian grocer at 355b Gladstone Road, open long hours daily, with online ordering for pickup

06 863 2953

bollywoodspicesgisborne.booknorder.co.nz

Thomman's Groceries (Gisborne)

Kerala and South Indian groceries: rice, spices, pickles and snacks. Check the site for pickup or delivery

gisborne.thommans.co.nz

Big Al's Bulk Barn

Bulk foods, including pulses, flours and spices, at 460 Gladstone Road

yellow.co.nz/gisborne/grocery

Halal meat

There's no dedicated halal butcher; ask the Muslim Association where members currently buy, or order frozen halal meat from Auckland or Hawke's Bay suppliers

facebook.com/Gisbornemuslims

Kosher food

Nothing kosher is sold locally. Families order from Auckland and Wellington suppliers through the Jewish community

nzjc.org.nz

Asian Grocer (online)

National online Asian grocer delivering to the regions; useful for anything local shops don't stock

asiangrocer.co.nz

SA Shop NZ (online)

South African groceries (rusks, biltong spices, Mrs Balls and more) delivered nationwide

sashopnz.co.nz

UK Foods (online)

British groceries delivered nationwide

ukfoods.co.nz

SUPERMARKETS & MARKETS

PAK'nSAVE Gisborne

The city's largest discount supermarket, on Childers Road

paknsave.co.nz

Woolworths Gisborne

Full-range supermarket at Gladstone Road and Carnarvon Street

woolworths.co.nz

SuperValue Kaiti

Supermarket at 504 Wainui Road for Kaiti and the eastern suburbs

yellow.co.nz/gisborne-region/supermarkets

Four Square (Elgin, Mangapapa, Wainui Road)

Neighbourhood supermarkets on Childers Road (Elgin), Ormond Road (Mangapapa) and Wainui Road (Kaiti)

foursquare.co.nz

Gisborne Farmers' Market

Every Saturday, 9.30am to 1pm, at the Old Army Hall carpark (Fitzherbert and Stout Streets), opposite the council: local growers, wine, coffee and live music
gizzylocal.com/event-details/gisborne-farmers-market

SCHOOLS, UNIFORMS & FAMILIES

Education Counts school finder

Look up schools, enrolment zones and school reports for any Gisborne address

educationcounts.govt.nz/find-school

School uniforms

Most Gisborne schools sell uniforms through their own uniform shop or office, and many hold second-hand sales. Ask the school when you enrol
educationcounts.govt.nz/find-school

HB Williams Memorial Library

The city library, with baby rhyme times, holiday programmes, free Wi-Fi and computers
gdc.govt.nz/recreation/library

Plunket

Free Well Child checks and parenting support for under-fives; PlunketLine is 24/7
0800 933 922 plunket.org.nz

Playcentre (Kaiti, Wainui and others)

Parent-led early childhood sessions; a quick way for new parents to meet locals
playcentre.org.nz

HOUSING & AREAS

Trade Me Property: Gisborne rentals

The main rental listings site; most landlords and property managers advertise here
trademe.co.nz/a/property/residential/rent/gisborne

realestate.co.nz: Gisborne rentals

A second set of rental listings from local agencies
realestate.co.nz/residential/rental/gisborne

Tenancy Services market rent tool

Check what a fair rent is for a suburb and house size before you apply
tenancy.govt.nz/rent-bond-and-bills/market-rent

Gisborne District Council: rates and property

Rates and property information for any address, plus flood and land-stability information worth checking before you buy
gdc.govt.nz

Trade Me flatmates

Rooms and flatshares, useful for your first few weeks
trademe.co.nz/a/property/flatmates-wanted

GETTING AROUND

GizzyBus

City buses linking the centre with the outer suburbs, Monday to Friday, 7am to 5.15pm, with a live bus map and school bus routes
gdc.govt.nz/services/transport-and-parking/bus-services

Bee Card

The fare card used on GizzyBus, with discounted fares and free transfers within 90 minutes. The national Motu Move payment system is being rolled out
beecard.co.nz

InterCity

The limited coach service to Napier and the Bay of Plenty
intercity.co.nz

Air New Zealand

Daily flights from Gisborne Airport, five minutes from town, to Auckland and Wellington
airnewzealand.co.nz

AA Driver & Vehicle Licensing, Gisborne

Licence conversions, vehicle registration and International Driving Permits at 198 Grey Street
aa.co.nz/drivers/driver-licences/locations

NZTA journey planner and road conditions

Check SH2 and SH35 for slips and closures before any drive out of the region
journeys.nzta.govt.nz

COST OF LIVING COMPARISONS

Numbeo: Gisborne

Crowd-sourced cost of living for Gisborne, which you can compare with your current city
numbeo.com/cost-of-living/in/Gisborne-New-Zealand

Powerswitch

Compare electricity and broadband plans for your address
powerswitch.org.nz

Sorted budget planner

A free government-backed tool for planning your first months' budget

sorted.org.nz

Stats NZ prices

Official food price and inflation data

stats.govt.nz

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Checked October 2026

Community groups, shops and pages change. If a link has moved or you know a group we should add, tell us and we will update the guide.

Numbers and websites to keep handy

The national services every newcomer uses, wherever in New Zealand you land.

EMERGENCIES & HEALTH ADVICE

Emergency services

Police, fire and ambulance, any time

111

Healthline

Free 24/7 health advice from a nurse, in any language

0800 611 116

Need to talk?

Free call or text a trained counsellor, 24/7

1737

National Poisons Centre

24/7 advice if someone may have been poisoned

0800 764 766

PlunketLine

Free 24/7 support for parents of under-fives

0800 933 922

VISAS, REGISTRATION & WORK

Immigration New Zealand

Visas, the Green List and residence pathways

immigration.govt.nz

Immigration Advisers Authority

Check an adviser is licensed before you pay

iaa.govt.nz

Responsible authorities

The registration board for every regulated health profession

health.govt.nz/regulated-health-professions

Nursing Council of New Zealand

Registration for nurses

nursingcouncil.org.nz

Medical Council of New Zealand

Registration for doctors

mcnz.org.nz

HEALTHCARE FOR YOUR FAMILY

Health New Zealand | Te Whatu Ora

How public healthcare works and who is eligible

tewhatuora.govt.nz

Healthpoint

Find a GP, pharmacy, dentist or urgent care near you

healthpoint.co.nz

ACC

Accident cover for everyone in New Zealand, including visitors

acc.co.nz

SCHOOLS & CHILDCARE

Find a school

Every school, with its enrolment zone

educationcounts.govt.nz/find-school

Education Review Office

Independent reports on schools and early learning

ero.govt.nz

Parents and whānau

How schooling, early childhood education and fees work

parents.education.govt.nz

MONEY, HOME & GETTING AROUND

Inland Revenue (IRD)

Your IRD number, tax and KiwiSaver
ird.govt.nz

Tenancy Services

Renting rules, bonds and market rents by area
tenancy.govt.nz

NZ Transport Agency

Converting your overseas driver licence
nzta.govt.nz/driver-licences

Powerswitch

Compare power companies in your area
powerswitch.org.nz

Sorted

Free, independent budgeting tools
sorted.org.nz

MPI · pets

Bringing cats and dogs into New Zealand
mpi.govt.nz/bring-send-to-nz/pets-travelling-to-nz

SETTLING IN

Citizens Advice Bureau

Free, confidential help with almost any question
0800 367 222 cab.org.nz

Ministry for Ethnic Communities

Support and connections for new migrant communities
ethniccommunities.govt.nz

Department of Conservation

Huts, tracks, campsites and Great Walks bookings
doc.govt.nz



Always check the source

Rules, fees and services change. Treat these as starting points and confirm details with the organisation. Ethicare are recruitment specialists, not licensed immigration advisers.

Six steps, and someone beside you for each one

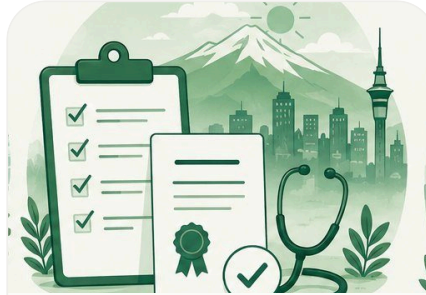
Moving country is a sequence of decisions. We take them with you in order, so you are never solving step five before step two is done.



STEP 1

Discovery call

A relaxed conversation about your profession, your family and what you want from a move. No forms, no pressure.



STEP 2

Eligibility & registration

We map your route to New Zealand registration and help you gather the evidence the regulator will ask for.



STEP 3

Opportunities & interviews

Roles matched to where you want to live and how you like to work, with honest briefings before every interview.



STEP 4

Offer & decision support

We help you read the offer properly: pay step, relocation support, roster and what the team is really like.



STEP 5

Visa & relocation guidance

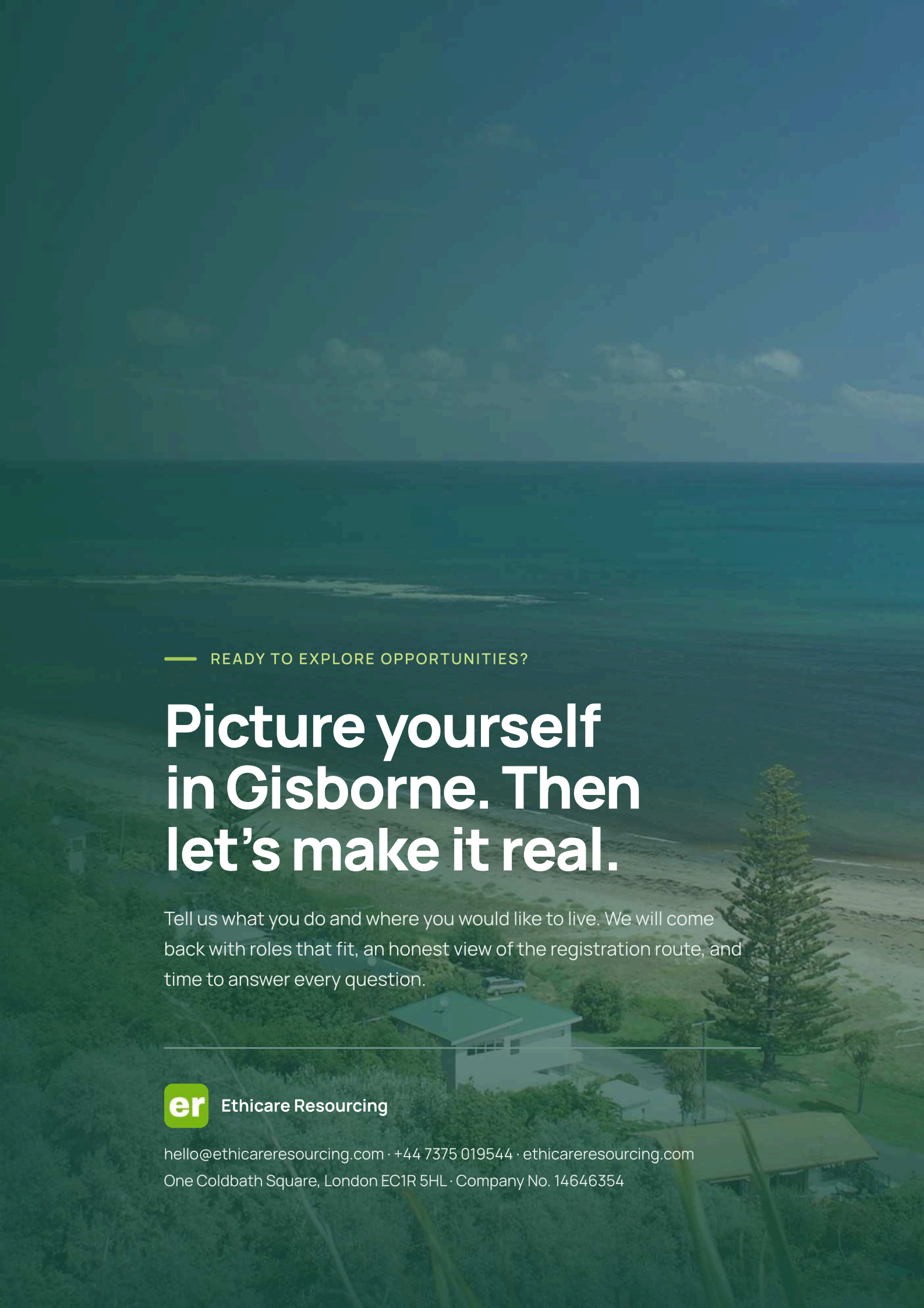
Practical guidance on visas, shipping, pets, schools and the first weeks, so nothing arrives as a surprise.



STEP 6

Settling in

We stay in touch after you land, from your first week on the ward to your first winter.

An aerial photograph of a coastal town, likely Gisborne, New Zealand. The image shows a sandy beach, a large body of water (the ocean), and a town with several buildings and a prominent tall pine tree. The sky is blue with some clouds. The entire image has a dark teal overlay.

— READY TO EXPLORE OPPORTUNITIES?

Picture yourself in Gisborne. Then let's make it real.

Tell us what you do and where you would like to live. We will come back with roles that fit, an honest view of the registration route, and time to answer every question.



Ethicare Resourcing

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